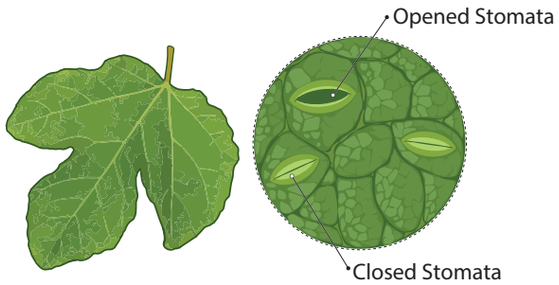
Stomata : Stomata are tiny openings or pores mostly found at the base of the leaves. Air enters and leaves the plant through these openings. Stomata helps the plants to breathe. Stomata are used to **exchange gases**.



1. Leaf as food factory

Plants need food but they never depend on people or animals to provide them. Most of the plants are able to make their own food through a process called **photosynthesis**.

Photosynthesis = Photo (light) + synthesis (make)

Photosynthesis is a process by which plants make their food using chlorophyll water, carbon dioxide in the presence of sunlight. Let us see how this process is organized with in the plants.

Think and answer

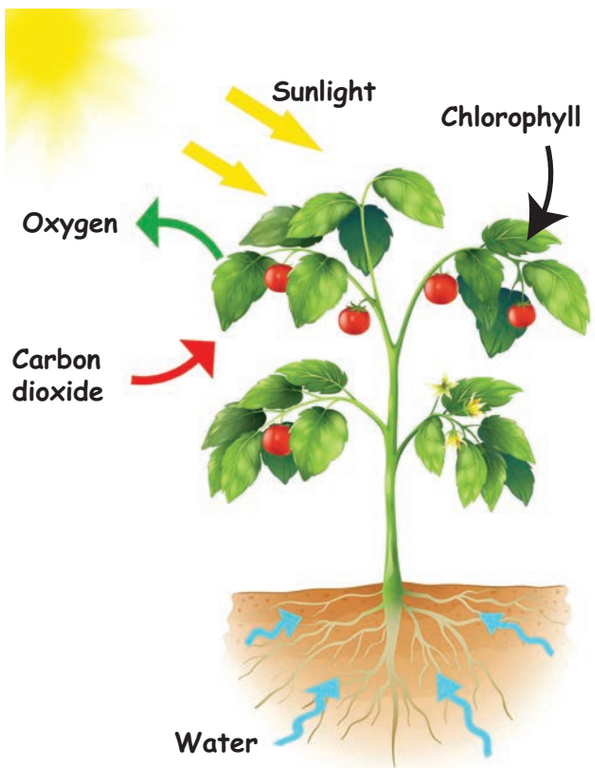
- Which part of the leaf collects carbon dioxide?
- Which part of the leaf transports water?

Water: Water is absorbed by the roots and is passed to the leaves through the tubes.

Carbon dioxide: Carbon dioxide in the air passes through small pores in the leaves.

Sunlight: A green pigment in the leaves help them to trap sunlight. This pigment is called **chlorophyll.** Most leaves are green in colour because of this green pigment.

Through photosynthesis plants produce the food and release oxygen into the air.



$$\text{Water} + \text{Carbon dioxide} \xrightarrow[\text{chlorophyll}]{\text{Sun light}} \text{Food} + \text{Oxygen}$$

As plants prepare food for themselves and also for other living things, they are called **primary producers**.

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